



Theater



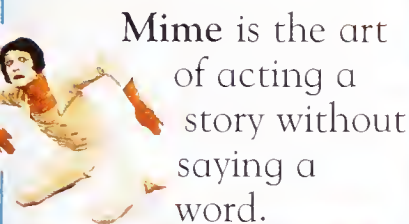
Types of plays



A **tragedy** is a serious play, with a sad ending.



Operas are plays performed by singers to music.



Mime is the art of acting a story without saying a word.



Comedies are funny plays, intended to make people laugh.

For thousands of years, people have enjoyed going to the theater for entertainment, watching actors perform.

Theater building

The audience sits in rows on several different levels. The actors perform on a stage.

Upstairs is called the balcony.

Downstairs is called the stalls.

Spotlight



Open-air theater

In some countries, theaters are built outdoors.



Chinese theater

In China, the costumes actors wear tell the audience about their characters.



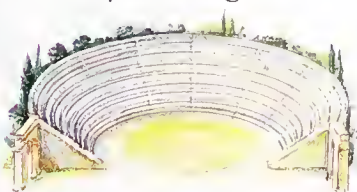
Indian theater

Traditional Indian plays tell stories. The actors mime, sing, and dance.



Did you know?

The first theaters were built in Greece about 2,500 years ago.



Puppet theater

Glove, string, and shadow puppets are popular in theaters around the world.



Judy



Punch



Crocodile

Glove puppets, like Punch and Judy, are popular in Britain.



Shadow puppets are used in Southeast Asia.



Marionettes have up to 20 strings to move them.

